

Assessment task 01: The Disciplinary Matrix of Architecture

Assessment Task 1: The Disciplinary Matric of Architecture

Submission Due Date: Week 5 | **Verbal Presentation** Monday In class | **Assignment Submission** Sunday 23 August 2026 Midnight

Weighting: 25%

Assessment Format: Individual

Word Count: approx. 150 words (*Excludes References*)

Learning Outcomes: Review the [Course Guide](#)

The assessment grade will be based on the rubric below and will include:

Learning outcomes

Your engagement with the coursework through Padlet, participation in lectures and tutorials.
Work in progress presentations in weekly tutorials.

Core competencies:

Core competencies included in the Architect's Accreditation Council of Australia (AACA) National Standard of Competency for Architects. Through successful achievement of the course learning outcomes listed above you will have demonstrated the following performance criteria:

PC1: Understand the **regulatory requirements** and **obligations** pertaining to practice as an architect, including **professional codes of conduct** and **obligations** for **continuing professional development** and **professional indemnity insurance**.

This assessment develops your ability to:

- understand the pathway to architectural registration
- distinguish between architecture, the architect and the architectural profession
- identify the institutions and mechanisms that shape professional practice

- synthesise lectures, readings and discussion into a coherent conceptual framework
- critically evaluate the profession rather than simply describe it
- communicate complex systems through diagrammatic thinking.

Introduction

Architecture is more than the production of buildings. It is a profession shaped by legislation, ethics, education, registration, procurement, research, institutions and a responsibility to serve the public good. These systems often remain invisible, yet they fundamentally influence what architects do and how the profession evolves.

Throughout this subject, each lecture introduces a different way of understanding the architectural profession. Rather than presenting isolated topics, the lectures progressively reveal the relationships, responsibilities and structures that underpin professional practice.

This assessment asks you to synthesise these perspectives into a single conceptual framework.

The objective is **not** to produce a comprehensive map of every organisation or process. Instead, you are asked to develop a diagram that explains **how the profession operates, why it exists, who it serves, and how it might evolve.**

The following quote offers guidance on the obligations professional have:

“A profession is a disciplined group of individuals who adhere to ethical standards and hold themselves out as, and are accepted by the public as possessing special knowledge. It is inherent in the definition of a profession that a code of ethics governs the activities of each profession. Such codes require behaviour and practice beyond the personal moral obligations of an individual. They define and demand high standards of behaviour in respect to the services provided to the public and in dealing with professional colleagues. Further, these codes are enforced by the profession and are acknowledged and accepted by the community.”

“What, then, if anything, distinguishes a profession from, say, a trade or craft? skills in a widely recognised body of learning derived from research, education and training at a high

level, and who are prepared to apply this knowledge and exercise these skills in the interest of others.”

Beaton, G. (2010). Why Professionalism is Still Relevant. U of Melbourne Legal Studies Research Paper No. 445, p.4-5.

Throughout this assessment consider:

- What distinguishes a profession from a business?
- What obligations do architects have beyond their clients?
- How is professional judgement developed?
- Who maintains professional standards?
- How does the profession continue to evolve?

Assessment Task

Develop an original **A1 Disciplinary Matrix** that explains the architectural profession through a process of iterative sketching, reflection and redrawing. The final submission should demonstrate how your understanding of the architectural profession has evolved throughout the semester.

Include a 150 word summary on HOW TO READ YOUR DIAGRAM and Critical Position.

Your diagram should demonstrate:

1. A Legible Pathway to Registration:

The pathway from architectural education through to registration as an Architect in Victoria should remain clearly visible throughout your diagram. Include required and expected time frames, gateways and contingencies. This pathway should become the organising spine of your work.

2. A Conceptual Framework:

Use the registration pathway as a foundation to explain relationships between:

- education including Continued Professional Development (CPD)
- employment

- registration including Insurance
- legislation
- professional bodies
- ethics including Professional Codes of Conduct
- procurement
- research
- public value
- innovation
- other concepts introduced throughout the semester.

Rather than listing these components, organise them into a coherent conceptual framework.

3. A Critical Position:

Move beyond describing the profession by identifying:

- where responsibility lies;
- who holds influence or power;
- where tensions or gaps exist;
- what may need to change; and
- how architecture might better serve society.

Use relational language such as:

- this enables;
- this limits;
- this depends upon;
- this influences;
- this causes; or
- this prevents.

Originality comes from the relationships and arguments you reveal, not from the quantity of information included.

Method: Thinking through drawing.

This assessment will be developed progressively throughout the semester. Each lecture introduces a different lens through which to understand the profession.

Stage 1 — Sketch Your Current Understanding

After the first lecture, produce a quick hand-drawn sketch showing how you currently understand the architectural profession.

Do not focus on accuracy, completeness or visual polish. The purpose is to make your existing understanding visible.

Stage 2 — Explore Conceptual Frameworks

In tutorials, you will examine different ways of organising complex systems, including:

- pathways;
- ecosystems;
- layered systems;
- networks;
- cycles; and
- hierarchies.

These are conceptual frameworks, not templates to copy. Select or adapt the approach that best communicates your own understanding. Bring them and discuss them in class with your tutor.

Stage 3 — Reorganise After Each Lecture

After each lecture, research the references, revisit your matrix rather than simply adding more boxes, arrows or information.

Ask:

- What has changed in my understanding?
- Which relationship has become more important?
- What should move, connect or be removed?
- Does the organising framework still make sense?
- Can the profession be explained more clearly?

Redraw the diagram when its underlying structure no longer communicates your ideas effectively.

Stage 4 — Refine Through Iteration

Your final matrix should be the outcome of multiple versions.

As your understanding develops, the diagram should become:

- clearer rather than more complex;
- more integrated rather than more detailed;
- more conceptual rather than descriptive; and
- more critical rather than observational.

The strongest submissions often contain fewer elements but reveal deeper relationships.

Assessment will focus on conceptual clarity, critical insight and the quality of the relationships communicated, rather than graphic polish alone.

Reference Images:

The precedent images included throughout the course are **not graphic styles to reproduce**.

Instead, they demonstrate different ways of organising complex information.

When viewing these examples, ask yourself:

- What organising principle is being used?
- Why has the author arranged information in this way?
- What relationships become visible?
- Could another framework explain the profession more clearly?

Assessment will focus on the quality of the conceptual framework rather than graphic style.

Pathways

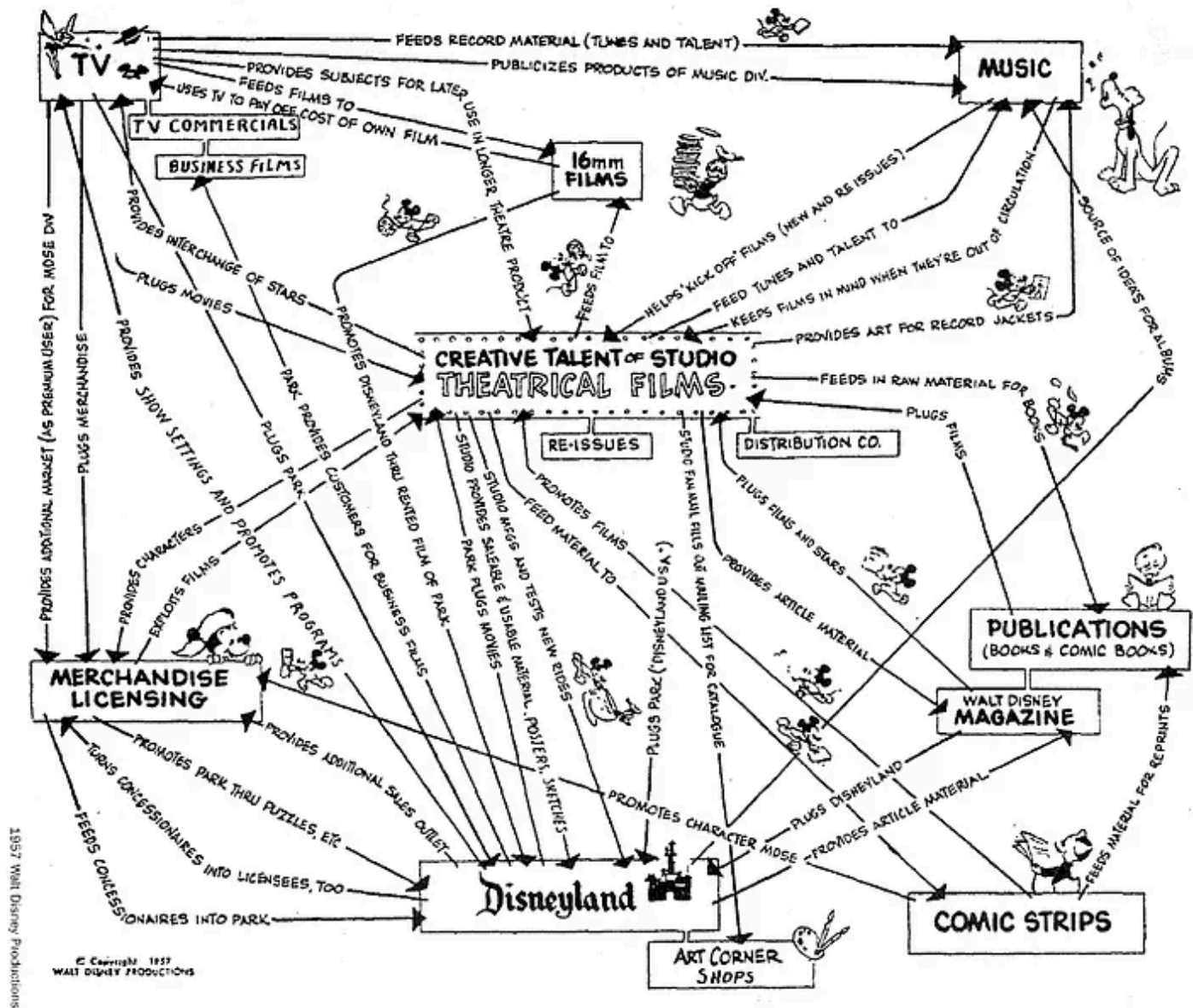
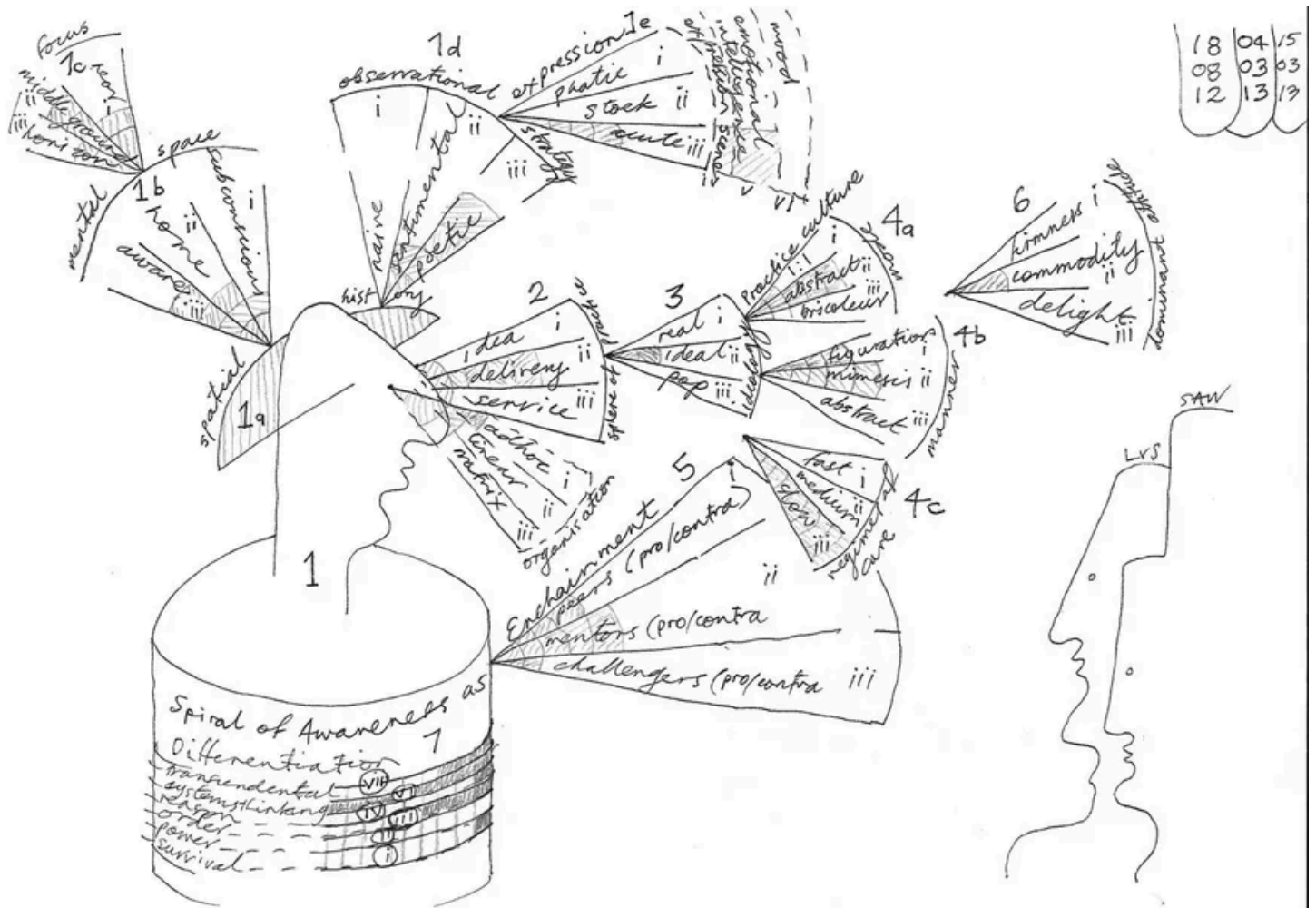


Image: 1957 "flywheel diagram" created by Walt Disney to map out his business empire strategy. [1, 2]

Pathways



Leon van Schaik, Differentiation, ideogram, 2012.

Ecosystems

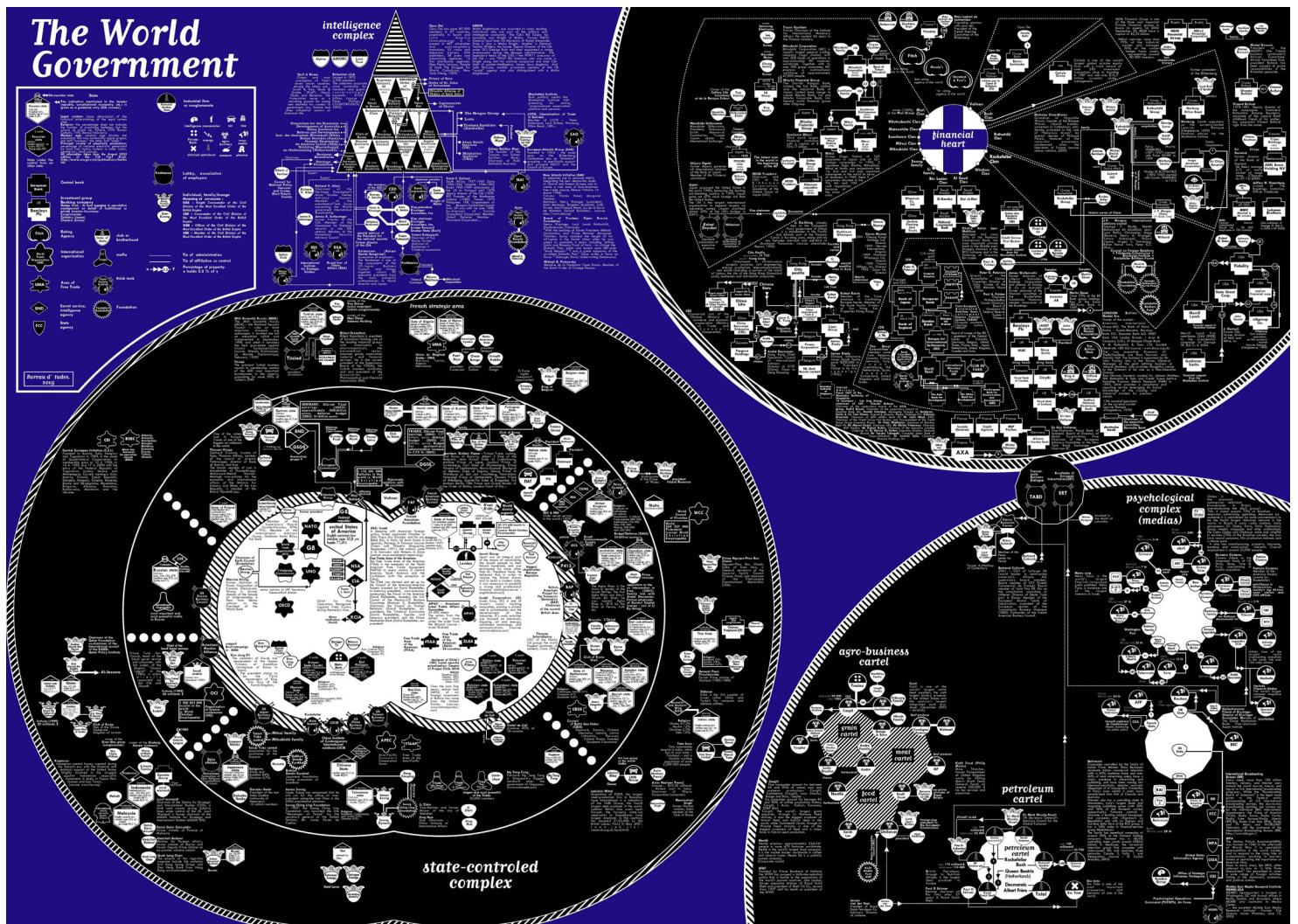
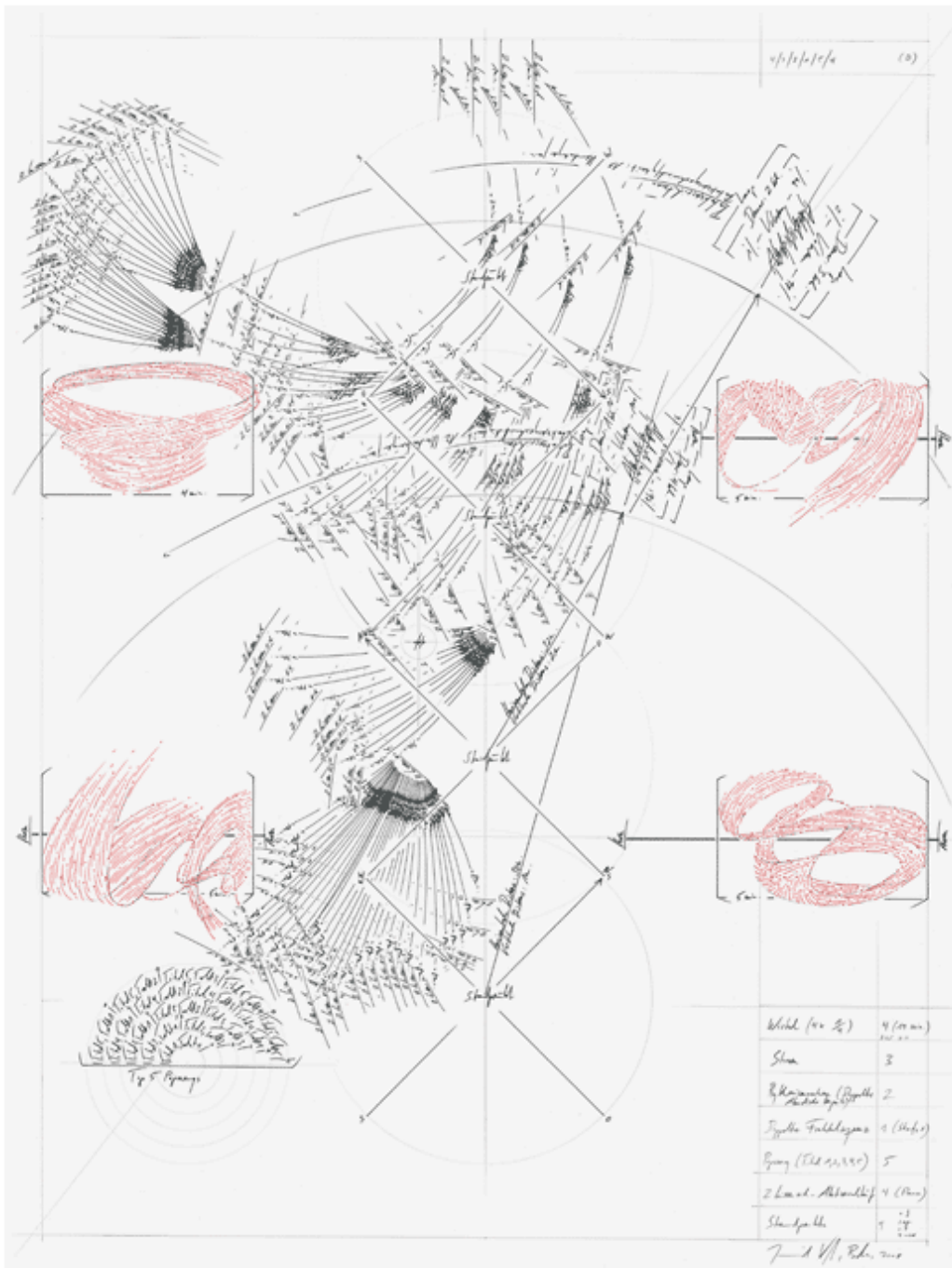


Image: "The World Government" map by bureau d'etudes

Layered Systems



[Jorinde Voigt's](#) drawings

Networks

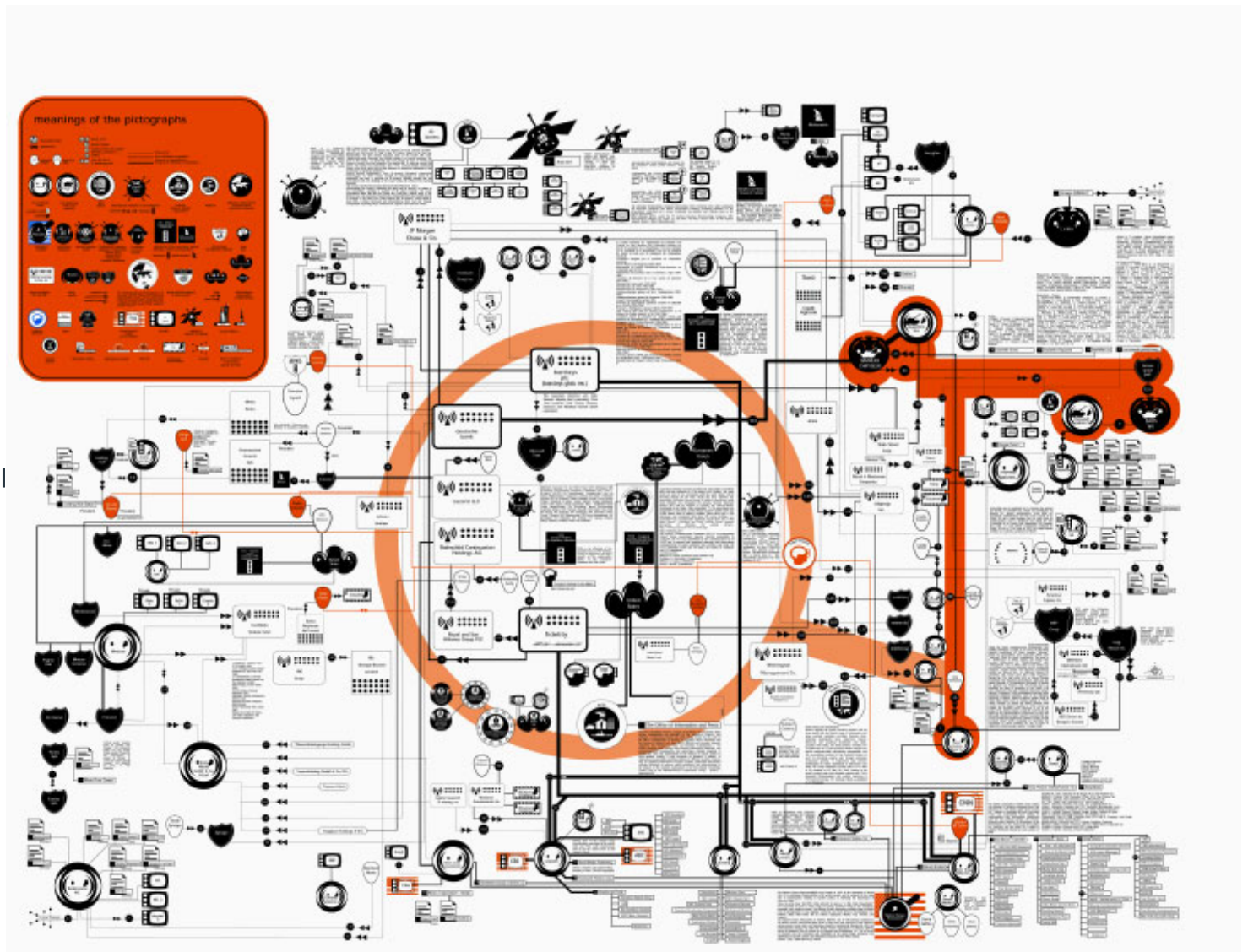
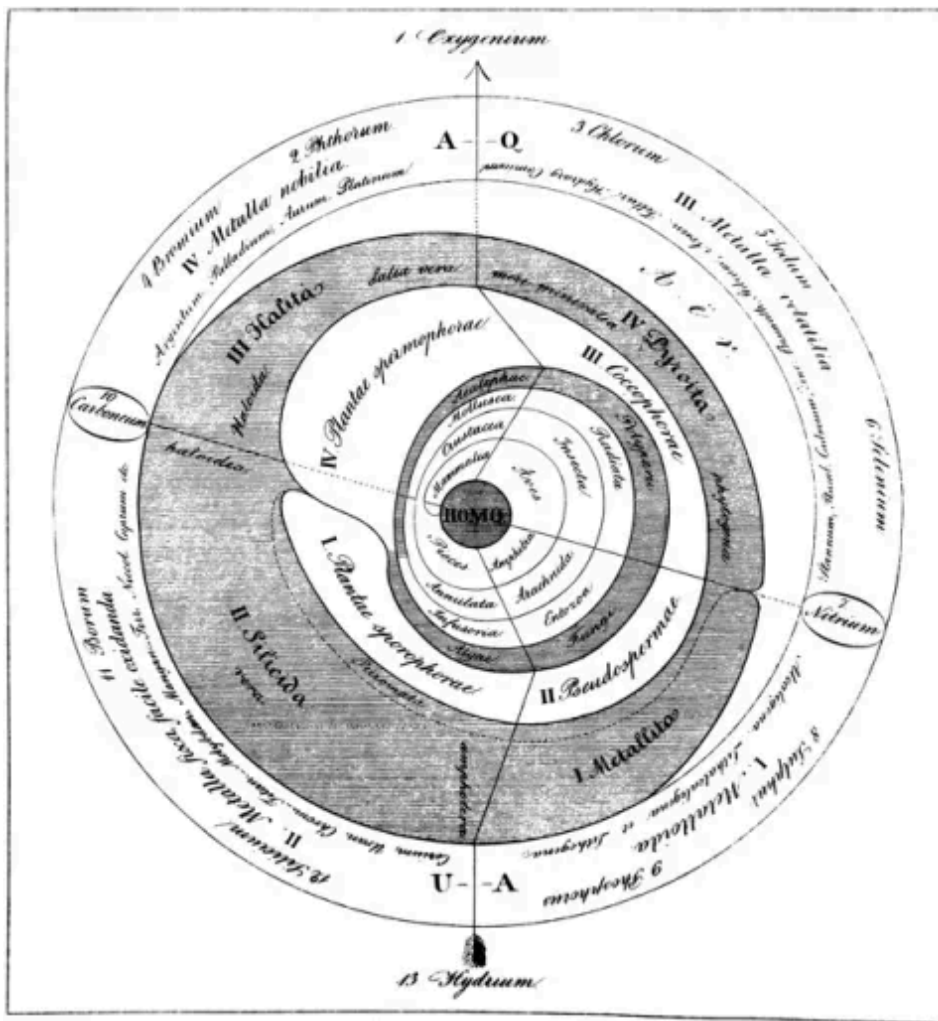


Image: mediaskills by bureau d'etudes

Cycles + Hierachies



Universal system of nature,' from Paul Horaninow's *Primae lineae systematis naturae* (Primary system of nature) of 1834,

Hierachies and Breaking down parts

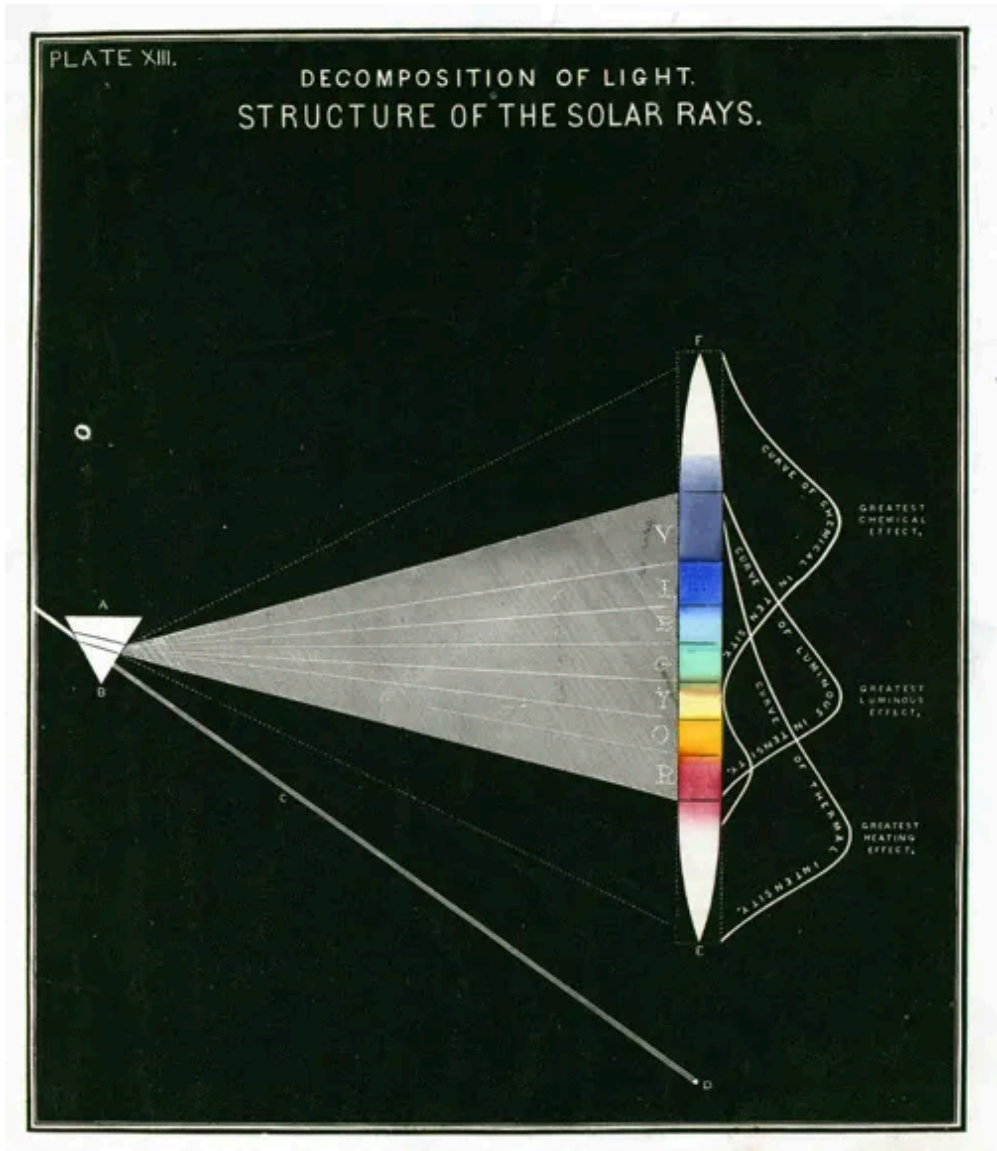


Plate XIII from Edward L. Youmans' 1856 book, [Chemical Atlas](#) ➞; or, [The Chemistry of Familiar Objects](#) ➞

Maps the different effects of these rays, highlighting the **greatest chemical, luminous, and heating** effects within the spectrum

Professional Practice Resource Map

The following resources provide a starting point for understanding the profession. Students are expected to critically interpret these resources rather than simply reproduce their content.

Category	Examples	Why it matters
Registration	Architectural Registration Board Victoria (ARBV),	Defines entry to the profession and competency requirements.

Category	Examples	Why it matters
	Architects Accreditation Council of Australia (AACA),	
Professional Institutes	Australian Institute of Architects (AIA), Australian Consulting Architects (ACA)	Advocacy, CPD, policy and professional culture.
Legislation	The Architects Act, Architects Regulations, The Building Act,	Establishes legal obligations and protects the public.
Codes & Ethics	AIA Code of Conduct, ACA Code of Conduct, National Construction Code	Guides professional judgement and professional behaviour.
Procurement	Australian Standard Contracts, Victorian Government Procurement	Explains how architects are commissioned and deliver projects.
Practice & Industry	Architeam, Parlour, Union for Architectural Workers	Business models, employment and practice management.
Research	Universities, Australian Qualifications Framework (AQF) RC, AHURI	Generates new knowledge and advances the profession.
Public Interest	The Victorian Building Authority (VBA), Building Act, Planning System, Local Government	Demonstrates architecture's broader civic responsibility.

Commonly Asked Questions Video

Step by Step How To Guide Video

Upload Instructions

- Present your work by uploading on the Monday WIP before class on the day of presentation.
- Upload the FINAL pdf by midnight on the due date.
- Include draft diagrams, an appendix and reference list as a combined PDF.
- **IMPORTANT: Name your files CORRECTLY**
StudentNo_Firstname_Lastname_Assessment Task XX
- *Note: Submit a video presentation using CANVAS STUDIO (click Studio tab and "record video") if you are not in class due to illness, travelling or intensive studio)*

Criteria	Ratings					
Conceptual Distillation	Outstanding Constructs an original conceptual framework that reveals new ways of understanding the profession. Demonstrates independent thinking and intellectual leadership.	Excellent Synthesises lectures, readings and discussion into a coherent and insightful conceptual framework.	Very Good Integrates major concepts with good synthesis.	Good Identifies major concepts but integration remains incomplete.	Adequate Demonstrates a basic understanding with limited synthesis.	Inadequate Limited understanding of key concepts.
Systems Thinking	Outstanding Reveals sophisticated relationships, hierarchies, feedback loops and leverage points. Explains the profession as an interconnected system.	Excellent Clearly explains relationships, responsibilities and tensions between institutions, individuals and professional mechanisms.	Very Good Demonstrates relationships between most components.	Good Identifies components with limited integration.	Adequate Components are largely isolated or descriptive.	Inadequate Limited understanding of professional systems.
Critical Position	Outstanding Develops an original and persuasive critique that extends beyond the lectures and proposes thoughtful opportunities for	Excellent Develops a clear critical position supported by lectures, tutorials and readings.	Very Good Demonstrates thoughtful critique with some independent insight.	Good Identifies issues but remains largely descriptive.	Adequate Limited critical engagement.	Inadequate Minimal evidence of critical reflection.

Criteria	Ratings					
	professional development.					
Diagrammatic Reasoning	Outstanding Diagram functions as an intellectual tool. The pathway to registration is seamlessly integrated into a highly legible conceptual framework that transforms understanding.	Excellent Diagram communicates hierarchy, relationships and argument clearly while maintaining a legible pathway to registration.	Very Good Diagram communicates ideas effectively with minor organisational issues.	Good Diagram communicates information but conceptual hierarchy could be strengthened.	Adequate Diagram contains useful information but lacks a clear organising framework.	Inadequate Diagram is incomplete or difficult to interpret.
[Lecture + Pre-reading Engagement] [Lecture + Pre-reading Engagement] Did the student consistently attend lectures and engage in pre-reading material to adequately meet the course learning outcomes?	YES			NO This student was absent for multiple lectures and did not engage with the pre-reading material which has impacted their ability to meet the course learning outcomes. TUTOR may identify the student as being in danger of failing. Substantial periods of absence or failure to present work in progress are to be noted in the feedback.		